- Population (0–6 years) 2001–2011 registered minus (–) 3.08 percent growth with minus (–) 2.42 for males and –3.80 for females
- The proportion of ***Child Population*** in the age group of 0–6 years to total population is ***13.1*** percent while the corresponding figure in 2001 was 15.9 percent. The decline has been to the extent of 2.8 points.
- Overall **sex ratio** at the national level has increased by 7 points to reach **940** at Census 2011 as against 933 in Census 2001. This is the ***highest*** sex ratio recorded since Census 1971 and a shade lower than 1961. Increase in sex ratio is observed in 29 States/UTs.
- Three major States (J&K, Bihar & Gujarat) have shown decline in sex ratio as compared to Census 2001.
- Kerala with 1084 has the **highest sex ratio** followed by Puducherry with 1038; Daman & Diu has the **lowest sex ratio** of 618.
- **Child sex ratio** (0–6 years) is 914. Increasing trend in the child sex ratio (0–6) seen in Punjab, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh, Gujarat, Tamil Nadu, Mizoram and A&N Islands. In all remaining 27 States/UTs, the child sex ratio show decline over Census 2001.
- Mizoram has the ***highest child sex ratio*** (0–6 years) of 971 followed by Meghalaya with 970. Haryana is at the bottom with ratio of 830 followed by Punjab with 846.
- **Literacy** rate has gone up from 64.83 per cent in 2001 to **74.04** per cent (*aged 7 and above*) in 2011 showing an increase of 9.21 percentage points. Percentage growth in literacy during 2001–2011 is 38.82; males: 31.98% and females: 49.10%.

The Way Ahead

The Census also talks about the rising population and the solutions regarding checking it. The discussion takes recourse to the famous Theory of Demographic Transition. A country which has added a size of population equa to the 5th most populous country in the world (Brazil), the pressure on the resources may be just imagined in India! The speed with which India is adding population poses a big challenge in front of almost every kind of *planning* in the country. The immediacy to check the rising population has